

A SAMPLE LESSON

The Capstone

BOOK FIVE · GRADES 11–12

Unit 1 · Lesson 1 — “The Exit Interview”

THE ARCHITECTURE OF GRACE · CURRICULUM

School of Life Foundation

The Exit Interview

50–55 min · August Week 1 · First lesson of Book 5

OBJECTIVE	Students conduct a structured self-examination of who they have been in high school — what they performed, what they actually built, and what they are choosing to carry forward — and write the first line of who they are choosing to become.
CASEL FOCUS	Self-Awareness (primary) · Responsible Decision-Making (supporting).
VOCABULARY	exit interview · transition identity · curated self · authentic self · carry-forward · leaving and arriving · threshold

ANCHOR CHART · THE THRESHOLD — LEAVING AND ARRIVING

The liminal space between who you have been and who you are becoming — you are standing in it right now. **The essential question:** of everything you have been and built in high school, what do you choose to carry through the threshold? What do you choose to leave behind?

OPENING RITUAL · 90 SEC

“Both feet on the floor. One breath slower than usual.” [Pause 15 seconds.] “This is the beginning of your last year of high school. This class will not ask you to manage those feelings. It will ask you to think honestly about who you are choosing to become.” Post: “Of everything you have been and built in high school — what do you choose to carry forward?”

DIRECT INSTRUCTION · STEPS 1–3

I The Exit Interview — Part 1: Who Have You Been? 10 MIN

“An exit interview is a structured conversation held when someone is leaving. Today you are conducting one with yourself — about your high school experience. Not the version for the college essay. The honest version.” 8 minutes of private writing: three identity roles I have played; two things I am genuinely proud of having built; one thing about my high-school identity I am not taking with me.

2

Part 2: Who Are You Arriving As? 10 MIN

"In the environment you are moving toward, none of the people you meet will know your history. They will only know who shows up. That is not a loss. It is an opportunity — and a responsibility." Students write privately: the three most essential qualities of the version of me I am sending into the next chapter — not the ones I perform, the ones that are actually mine. Then: "The first line of who I am choosing to become: ____."

3

The Continuity Question 10 MIN

"Of everything you have built in yourself — the values, the relationships, the capacity for grace — what travels through the threshold with you, and how does it travel when the context that held it is gone?" Students write: the thing about who I am most at risk of being lost in the transition is ____; what holds it in place is ____.

IN-LESSON SCAN

Observe: in Step 1, a student who writes intensely about a role they clearly did not choose — one assigned by family, community, or circumstance. **May signal:** an identity shaped by others' expectations; the threshold may be both terrifying and liberating. **Action:** do not approach during the lesson; after class, open the door gently.

SCENARIO CARDS · B5-1A & B5-1B

Sofia can articulate her record but not herself: "Who were you becoming here — beneath the record?" **Darius** has been the class clown since sixth grade: "I don't think that's who I want to be anymore, but I don't know who I am without it." *Releasing an identity is not the same as erasing it.*

EXIT TICKET · JOURNAL (NEVER COLLECTED, NEVER GRADED)

"Three roles I have played are _____. The version of me I am sending forward has these qualities: _____. The thing most at risk of being lost is ____; what holds it in place is _____."

FAMILY CONNECTION · CONVERSATION STARTER

The first lesson asked students to conduct an Exit Interview with themselves. A starter: "Is there a version of you in high school that you're ready to leave behind? And is there something you've built here that you want to make sure travels with you?"

THIS LESSON INCLUDES

Anchor Chart

Scenario Cards B5-1A / B5-1B

Exit Interview Journal

END OF THE SAMPLE LESSON

What is portable. What you have built. The architecture that goes with you.

The Capstone · Book Five of The Architecture of Grace · Grades 11–12